



Q

What is the recommended headspace for canning most fruits in a water bath canner?



ANSWER

1/2 inch to 1 inch depending on the fruit

FUN FACT

Correct headspace prevents bubbling out and ensures a proper vacuum seal.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

Q

What is the main advantage of the hot pack method over raw pack when canning fruits?



ANSWER

Fruits are softer, easier to pack, and have less floating fruit

FUN FACT

Hot packing often preserves the color of light-colored fruits better.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

When canning Asian pears, what must be added to the jars to ensure safe acidity?

ANSWER

Bottled lemon juice (2 tablespoons per quart or 1 tablespoon per pint)

FUN FACT

Asian pears are lower in acid than Bartlett pears and require added acid for safety.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What is the processing time for hot-packed apricots at an altitude of 0-1000 feet using pints?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

20 minutes

FUN FACT

Processing times increase with altitude to ensure safe preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

Q

Why should white-flesh peaches not be canned using boiling water canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

Their natural pH can make boiling water canning unsafe; no tested safe times exist

FUN FACT

Freezing is recommended as a safe alternative for white-flesh peaches.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

How should you prevent floating fruit during packing in canning jars?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

Use hot pack method and boiling syrup, water, or juice

FUN FACT

Hot packing reduces air in fruit, decreasing floating during processing.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What is the recommended procedure if a jar does not seal after canning fruits?



ANSWER

**Reprocess within 24 hours
using new lids and full time**

FUN FACT

*Reprocessing may reduce firmness
and nutrition slightly but preserves
safety.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

When packing fruit raw (raw pack), what should be done to the fruit before packing?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

Pack unheated fruit into hot jars and cover with boiling syrup, water, or juice

FUN FACT

Raw pack produces firmer texture but may require longer processing time.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

How much sugar is typically added per gallon of fruit juice to be canned for flavor and preservation?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

1 cup sugar per gallon juice, if desired

FUN FACT

Sugar is optional and can be omitted without compromising safety.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

What is the best way to prepare jars to prevent breakage during canning?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

Preheat empty jars in the canner at 140°F for raw pack and 180°F for hot pack

FUN FACT

Preheating jars reduces thermal shock and potential jar breakage.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

Q

Why is it important not to adjust tested canning recipes by changing sugar or acid levels?



ANSWER

Altering sugar or acid affects safety and can lead to spoilage or unsafe food

FUN FACT

Tested recipes are balanced for both safety and quality preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What syrup type is considered 'light' for canning fruits, and how is it prepared?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

Light syrup: 1 1/2 cups sugar to 5 3/4 cups water, boiled then poured over fruit

FUN FACT

Different syrup strengths affect sweetness and yield but not safety.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

How should you handle jars and lids during closing to ensure a good seal?



ANSWER

Wipe jar rims clean and follow manufacturer instructions for lid and band tightening

FUN FACT

Too tight bands can prevent air venting and cause lids to buckle.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What is the minimum processing time for cherries in pints at altitudes above 6000 ft using the hot pack method?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

25 minutes

FUN FACT

Processing times increase with elevation to maintain safety standards.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

Q

What should you do if the water in your boiling water canner stops boiling during the entire processing time?

ANSWER

Bring water back to boil and begin timing over from the start

FUN FACT

Maintaining a steady boil ensures proper heat penetration and safe preservation.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Adults

Q

What is the recommended jar size for canning fruit juices safely at home?



ANSWER

**Pints, quarts, and 1/2 gallons
with recommended processing
times**

FUN FACT

*Properly sized jars help ensure
consistent heat processing during
canning.*

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

Why is using a rack inside your boiling water canner important?

ANSWER

It prevents jars from touching the canner bottom and allows even heat circulation

FUN FACT

Even heating reduces the risk of jar breakage and underprocessing.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits



Q

What is the best method to remove air bubbles from jars after filling before processing?



ANSWER

Run a plastic or nonmetal utensil around inside the jar

FUN FACT

Removing air bubbles helps prevent floating fruit and ensures good seals.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

How long should empty jars be boiled to sterilize them before canning if processing time is less than 10 minutes?



ANSWER

10 minutes at altitudes less than 1,000 feet

FUN FACT

Sterilizing jars is essential to prevent microbial contamination when processing times are short.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits

Q

What is the typical processing time for canning rhubarb using a hot pack at altitudes below 1000 feet?

CANNING FRUITS



Adults

ANSWER

15 minutes

FUN FACT

Rhubarb, being acidic enough, can be safely processed in boiling water canner.

Source: PNW 199 Canning fruits